# AN AGENTIC FRAMEWORK FOR THE SINGLE ORGANISING IDEA

*Helping SMEs identify, define and align around their organisational purpose*

Mission Ready HQ · Industry Challenge Brief
10-week team placement

Prepared by Seen Ventures, for the Mission Ready HQ cohort
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# The challenge, in one line

**What we want your team to build**

Design and build an agentic framework for Seen Ventures' proprietary SOI® methodology — a set of coordinated AI agents, not a single chatbot — that takes a small or medium-sized business (SME) through the method's three stages (Identifying, Defining, Aligning) to arrive at its own Single Organising Idea, without a human consultant running the room.

# Background

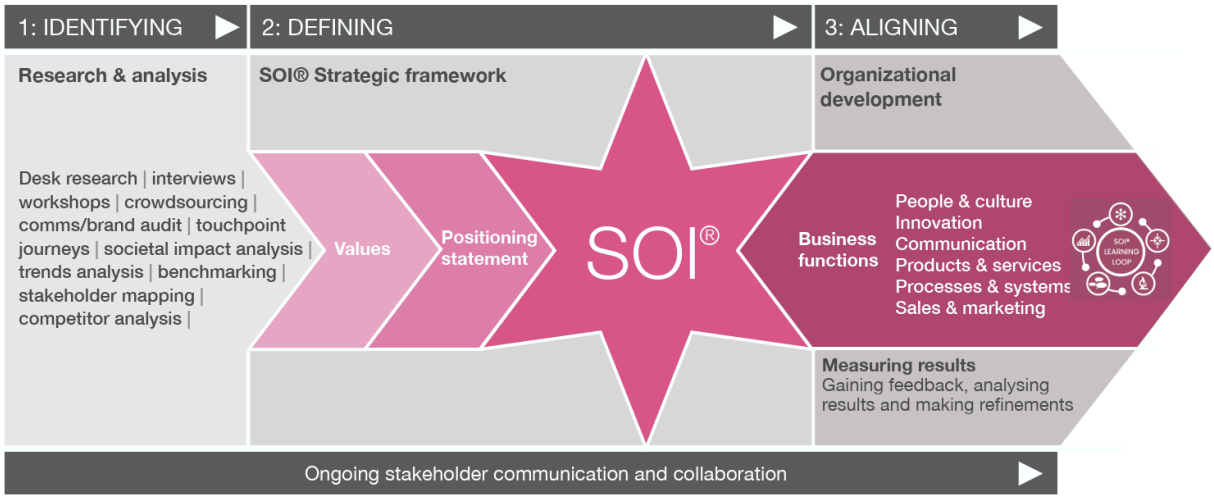
Seen Ventures is working with Neil Gaught & Associates (NG&A) to look at the potential to commercialise the Single Organising Idea, or SOI®,  a trademarked, 20 year old methodology that helps organisations define a single, unifying purpose and align strategy, culture and decisions around it. SOI® is documented in Neil Gaught's book CORE and has been used with enterprise boards and public-sector organisations across 60+ countries.

Today, SOI is delivered the traditional way: a skilled facilitator runs research, workshops and alignment sessions with leadership teams over weeks or months. That works well at enterprise-board level, where clients pay for bespoke, high-trust facilitation. It does not reach the millions of SMEs who could benefit from a clearer sense of purpose but can't justify — or access — a consultant-led engagement.

That gap is the opportunity for this challenge. If the method can be codified into an agentic framework, SMEs get a low-cost, self-serve way to work through the method and help move Aotearoa NZ to becoming the purpose capital of the world.

# The SOI® method

The diagram below is the method as Seen Ventures and NG&A deliver it today, and it's the shape your agentic framework should follow. It runs left to right through three stages, underpinned throughout by stakeholder communication and collaboration, and closed by a measurement and learning loop that feeds back into the whole process.




| 1 · IDENTIFYING | 2 · DEFINING | 3 · ALIGNING |
|---|---|---|
| **Research & analysis** | **SOI® strategic framework** | **Organisational development** |
| Desk research, interviews, workshops, comms audit, touchpoint journeys, trends analysis, benchmarking, stakeholder mapping, competitor analysis. | Values → Positioning statement → the Single Organising Idea (SOI®) itself. | Cascading the SOI into people & culture, innovation, communication, products & services, processes & systems, sales & marketing. |

- **Identifying.** Gathering the raw material: what the business actually does, for whom, what its people and stakeholders believe about it, and how it compares to others in its space.
- **Defining.** Working that raw material up through a strategic framework: first the organisation's Values, then a Positioning Statement, then the Single Organising Idea itself.
- **Aligning.** Cascading the agreed SOI into how the business actually operates — its people and culture, innovation, communication, products and services, processes and systems, and sales and marketing.
- **Measuring & learning.** Gathering feedback, analysing results and refining the SOI and its alignment over time, the method is a loop, not a one-off exercise.

# The problem this solves

- **SMEs often lack a formal strategy.** Even if they have clarity of purpose, they often cannot connect this to their strategic vision, focus areas, measures, and decision-making due to a lack of time and capacity to put this into practice, and they rely on external advisors or consultants to help them do this.

- **A purpose statement doesn't make a business purpose-driven.** Around 70% of ASX100 companies state a purpose, but fewer than 40% connect it meaningfully to what the business actually does (Griffith University / Future Normal / Brandpie, 2024). The statement exists; the operating system underneath it doesn't.
- **Purpose isn't governable.** Boards and owners have no standard way to govern through purpose, it's rarely visible, measurable or actionable at governance level, so it can't inform decisions the way strategy or risk do.
- **Purpose work doesn't survive its own launch.** Purpose initiatives commonly fail at execution: leadership changes, the consultant's engagement ends, and alignment drifts, because there's no ongoing system holding it in place.
- **Measurement tools track the wrong thing.** Existing ESG, CSR and reporting tools measure outputs, not the connection between purpose and strategic decisions, culture, investment and governance they report on purpose, they don't run the business by it.
- **And the current method doesn't scale down.** On top of all that, a proper human-led SOI engagement costs more than most SMEs can justify, takes months, and there aren't enough certified facilitators to serve that market even if the price were right.

# What we mean by "agentic framework"

We're not asking for a single prompt that outputs a purpose statement. We're asking for a small set of co-operating agents, each responsible for a stage of the method, that hand context to one another the way a human consulting team would — the research feeds the definition, the agreed SOI briefs the alignment work, and results flow back into both. At minimum, the framework your team builds should be able to:

- **An Identifying agent.** Gather the raw material a business needs before it can define anything — through structured conversation with the SME, and, where feasible, lightweight research of its own (competitor scan, public information, customer or staff input) — mirroring the desk research and stakeholder mapping a human team would do.
- **A Defining agent.** Take that raw material through the SOI strategic framework — drafting Values, then a Positioning Statement, then converging on the Single Organising Idea — probing vague or contradictory answers rather than accepting the first one.
- **An Aligning agent.** Turn an agreed SOI into a first-pass view of what needs to change in each business function — people & culture, innovation, communication, products & services, processes & systems, sales & marketing — not just a restatement of the SOI under each heading.
- **A measurement / learning loop.** Capture feedback and results (even lightly) and feed them back to refine the SOI or its alignment — the method is designed as a loop, and the framework should behave like one.
- **Orchestration and human-in-the-loop.** Hand off cleanly between agents and back to the human user at each stage, so the SME can steer, correct or pause — stakeholder

communication and collaboration runs throughout the real method, and the framework shouldn't automate people out of the checkpoints they'd want to be part of.

# Who it's for

The primary user is the owner, founder or board director of a small-to-medium business (roughly 5-150 staff) who is curious about aligning their organisation's strategy and execution to purpose but cannot afford to engage a consultancy to craft it and maintain it. Assume limited patience for long forms, no prior exposure to SOI or purpose frameworks, and a strong "prove it's worth my time" bar in the first few minutes.

# Constraints and guardrails

- **IP and confidentiality.** SOI® is a registered trademark treat all framework materials as confidential; anything built during the challenge should be handled the same way, and the team should ensure they have signed the Seen Ventures NDA.
- **Explainability over cleverness.** Each agent's reasoning should be inspectable, showing which inputs led to a given Value, Positioning Statement or SOI, rather than opaque single-prompt generation. This matters both for user trust and because Seen Ventures needs to evaluate whether the method survives being delivered by AI.
- **User data handling.** Any business information a user shares should be handled as sensitive by default no assumptions that it can be reused, stored indefinitely or shared beyond the prototype's test environment.

# What good looks like

At the end of the 10 weeks, success looks like:

- **Real users, real recognition.** We are ready to take a handful of real SME owners through the framework and recognise the resulting Values, Positioning Statement and SOI as genuinely theirs, not a generic guess.
- **Method fidelity, stage by stage.** A person familiar with the SOI method looking at the agents' transcripts and outputs would say each stage is asking substantially the right kinds of questions, not just producing plausible-sounding statements.
- **Tangible artefacts.** A working prototype, its transcripts/logs, and a short write-up of what worked, what didn't, and what the team would do with another 10 weeks.